perception of decision-making processes, some on regional integration, others on impact of domestic and bureaucratic politics on foreign policy or the roles played by transnational actors in world politics. To attempt to combine islands of theory does not necessarily result in a general theory.

Further, the pluralists downplay the role of anarchy and security dilemma in analysing international relations, which has been criticized by the realists as an incomplete analysis. For, no analysis of world politics is complete unless the anarchical structure of the system is not taken into account. The realists allege that such kinds of thinking tend to be utopian.

The pluralists have also been criticized by many for viewing the world through the lenses of American political system. This has been refuted by the pluralists who acknowledge cultural, societal and other differences. They argue that bureaucracies, interest groups and transnational actors are important for a better understanding of international relations and deny that this image is purely American ethnocentrism imposed on the globe. Yet, critics do find the pluralist vision of the world suffering from American ethnocentrism.[22]